QP CODE 25900437

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) Regular EXAMINATION October 2025

Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Elective (DSE) - MG3DSEHIS201 – HISTORY OF PRINTING AND PUBLISHING IN INDIA

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Part A

MCQ

Answer any **10** questions Each question carries **1** marks

1. a. Mesopotamia
2. a. Wood pulp
3. a. Richard Hoe
4. b. Oil based ink
5. a. Codex
6. c. C. P. Brown
7. d. 1766
8. b. Jawaharlal Nehru
9. c. Mahatma Gandhi
10. b. Bal Gangadhar Tilak
11. a, M. P. Paul
12. d. 1964 (1 x 10 = 10)

Part B

SHORT ANSWER

Answer any **5** questions Each question carries **2** marks

13. A paperback book has a flexible cover made of thick paper or paperboard, distinguishing it from a hardcover book with a stiff cover. They are typically lighter, more portable, and less expensive to produce and purchase than hard covers.
14. D. Raghavan wrote the book “An Introduction to Book Publishing”.
15. Religious textbooks, dictionaries, grammar books, Government reports and policy documents.

16. The Serampore Press, also known as the Serampore Mission Press, was a printing press established in Serampore, Danish India, by the British Baptist missionaries William Carey, William Ward, and Joshua Marshman in 1800. Initially focused on religious texts, it became a major center for printing in Bengal.
17. The first printed magazine was the Jnananikshepam in 1848. It was printed from CMS press Kottayam.
18. Kandathil Varghese Mappilai was the founder-editor of Malayala Manorama.
19. Newspaper spread the message of nationalism. They wrote articles in newspapers. The Press was the chief instrument for carrying out the main political tasks. Political propaganda, education and formation and propagation of nationalist ideology to awake, train, mobilize and consolidate nationalist public opinion.
20. Pocket books are small, portable books that are designed to be compact and lightweight, making them easy to carry in a pocket or purse. (2 x 5 = 10)

Part C

SHORT ESSAY

Answer any **4** questions Each question carries **5** marks

21. The purpose of block printing is to spread of information.
22. Grammar text and dictionaries are the basic text used to learn a language. Many missionaries came from foreign nations to India. They forced to learn our languages. So the printing of this text was very necessary. It increased the growth of printing and publishing. Missionaries started educational institutions. It created the need for study materials. Growth of schools enhanced the use of printed books. It flourished printing.
23. Dr. Hermann Gundert was a famous Basel missionary. The Basel mission centers in India were Thalassery and Mangalapuram. Dr. Hermann Gundert started Rajyasamacharam and Paschimodayam from Illikkunnu in 1847. This is known as the earliest newspapers in Malayalam.
24. Newspapers united people against colonial oppression by acting as a crucial tool for communication, education, and mobilization, thereby fostering a sense of shared identity and purpose across diverse populations.
25. Mathrubhoomi played a pivotal role in India's freedom struggle, particularly in Kerala. Founded in 1923 by K.P. Kesava Menon, it served as a powerful mouthpiece for the nationalist movement. Major contributions are: Spreading Nationalist Ideology, Criticizing British Rule, Mobilizing Public Opinio, Promoting Social Reforms, Providing a Platform for National Leaders.
26. Hicky's Bengal Gazette was a pioneering English-language newspaper in India, founded by James Augustus Hicky in 1780. Hicky's Bengal Gazette played a significant role in shaping the media landscape in India and influencing the development of journalism in the country.
27. Major sectors of publishing industry in India are public sectors under Central government, state government and public sector. (5 x 4 =20)

Part D

ESSAY

Answer any 4 questions Each question carries 5 marks

28. India has a rich history of ancient writing systems, with several scripts emerging over time. Some notable ones include: Brahmi script, Indus script, Kharoshthi script etc.
29. Madras is known as the cradle of publishing. Madras played a significant role in the history of printing in India. Madras was one of the earliest locations in India to have a printing press, established by the British in the 17th century.
30. The press played a pivotal role in spreading reform movements across India during the 19th and 20th centuries. Newspapers like Bengal Gazette and Amrita Bazar Patrika promoted social and educational reforms, advocating for women's rights and education. The press highlighted social issues, raising awareness and sparking public debate. The press provided a platform for reformers to express their views, amplifying their message and impact.
31. **NBT:** National Book Trust functioned as an autonomous body under the Ministry of Human Resource Development. It has had an extensive publishing programme to bring books under different series and make these available to the readers at moderate prices. Books under “India – The Land and the People”, National Biography series, Adan Pradan, Nehru Bala Pustakalaya and Young India Library series etc.

    CBT: Children’s Book Trust (CBT) is a pioneer publisher of children’s books in India and was founded by cartoonist Shankar in 1957. Children’s Book Trust has set for itself an ambitious target to promote the production of well written, well illustrated and well designed books for children. CBT brought out its first set of illustrated books in 1961.
32. **NCERT:** The NCERT coordinates the works of the state textbook producing organizations in addition to publishing model textbooks for adoption by schools. The universities and institutions of advanced studies in different fields of research and learning, run on government funds, also publish books of a scholarly matter. (15 x 2 = 30)